

53 Old and new situations

New situations may seem unusual, but over time they become familiar. You can use phrases that contain “be used to” and “get used to” to talk about this.

-  **New language** “Be used to” and “get used to”
- Aa Vocabulary** Moving and living abroad
-  **New skill** Talking about old and new situations

53.1 KEY LANGUAGE “BE USED TO” AND “GET USED TO”

To “get used to (doing something)” means that you adapt to new or different circumstances so that they become familiar.

Waking up early for my new job was difficult at first, but eventually I **got used to it.**



To “be used to (doing something)” means that you have done it long enough that it is normal and familiar.

I’ve lived in the city for years, so I **am used to the bad pollution.**



53.2 FURTHER EXAMPLES “BE USED TO” AND “GET USED TO”



When I travel, I **get used to different customs very quickly.**

[I find it easy to adapt to different customs when I travel.]



I **got used to the cold weather within a couple of weeks.**

[I adapted to the cold weather within two weeks.]



I **am used to spicy food as I’ve always eaten it.**

[I am accustomed to eating spicy food.]



We **were used to the old teacher, so it was a shame when she left.**

[We were accustomed to our previous teacher, but then she left.]

TIP

Do not confuse these phrases with “used to” (without “be” or “get”), which is used when talking about a regular past action.

